

The Noble Dhāraṇī Called 'Refuge for Many Children'

Ārya-bahu-putra-pratisaraṇā-nāma-dhāraṇī · Toh 615 · Derge Kangyur

འཕགས་པ་བ་ཕུང་པ་རྫོགས་པ་ཞེས་བ་བྱའ་གི་ཟུངས།

Toh 615 in the Kangyur is a dhāraṇī text known in English as "Refuge for Many Children," in Sanskrit as the Ārya-bahu-putra-pratisaraṇā-nāma-dhāraṇī, and in Tibetan as the Phags pa bu mang po rton pa zhes bya ba'i gzungs. It belongs to the dhāraṇī section of the Kangyur, a class of texts centered on sacred formulae believed to confer protection and spiritual benefit. The text is framed as a discourse delivered by the Buddha at Śrāvastī, prompted by the householder Anāthapiṇḍada, who approaches the Blessed One seeking guidance after finding himself in a legal dispute with King Prasenajit. In response, the Buddha imparts a dhāraṇī whose title suggests it serves as a refuge or protection particularly in contexts involving children or dependents. The translation into Tibetan is attributed to the translator Bandé Yeshé Dé, whose work was later revised in accordance with updated terminological conventions.

The noble dhāraṇī called "Refuge for Many Children."

In the language of India: Ārya-bahu-putra-pratisaraṇā-nāma-dhāraṇī. In the Tibetan language: the noble dhāraṇī called "Refuge for Many Children."

Homage to all the buddhas and bodhisattvas.

Thus did I hear. At one time the Blessed One was dwelling at Śrāvastī, in the Jeta Grove of Prince Jeta, in the garden of Anāthapiṇḍada. At that time the householder Anāthapiṇḍada went to where the Blessed One was, arrived there, bowed his head at the feet of the Blessed One, and said these words to the Blessed One:

"Blessed One, today I find myself here in a quarrel and dispute with King Prasenajit, exposed and laid bare. Blessed One, how should I proceed in this matter?"

When he had spoken thus, the Blessed One said these words to the householder Anāthapiṇḍada:

"Householder, therefore take up this vidyā-mantra called 'Refuge for Many Children,' receive it, retain it, and bring it to full accomplishment.

Tadyathā: daḍe, badadḍe, upadaḍadadḍe, upadaḍedaḍa, gambhīrī, avartane, nivartane, dhahidhahi, avartani, dāgi, sarveśānakarmī, kānāṃ, pratyarthikānāṃ, pratyamotriṇāṃ, cakṣurmohānāṃ karomi, śrotramohānāṃ karomi, jihvāgrāṇāṃ karomi, jihvāmahājambhānāṃ, stambhānāṃ, mohānāṃ, pramohānāṃ.

Householder, if anyone ties this dhāraṇī of 'Refuge for Many Children' onto a red thread, reciting the mantra seven times and binding it to a single finger of the left hand, then no poison, weapon, illness, epidemic, or fierce plague shall have power over that person's body. Battles, disputes, and quarrels shall be turned back upon those who bring them."

Having declared this, the Blessed One spoke thus, and the householder Anāthapiṇḍada rejoiced and praised what the Blessed One had said.

The noble dhāraṇī called "Refuge for Many Children" is complete.

Translated and edited by the Indian masters Jinamitra and Dānaśīla, together with the chief translator, the monk Yeshé Dé, and definitively established.

Translator's Notes

- The mantra syllables are preserved in transliteration as is standard for dhāraṇī texts; their phonological reconstruction from the Tibetan is approximate. The colophon appears twice in the source in slightly varying forms — once at the opening (without the names of the Indian paṇḍitas) and once at the close (with the full attribution to Jinamitra, Dānaśīla, and Yeshé Dé); both are rendered in order. The name Anāthapiṇḍada (Tibetan: Mgon med zas sbyin, "Feeder of the Destitute") is a well-known epithet of the wealthy merchant patron of the Buddha, here rendered by his Sanskrit name for clarity. King Prasenajit (Tibetan: Gsal rgyal) is the king of Kosala and a familiar figure in the sūtra literature.

Colophon

This is an AI-generated translation from the AI Stupa project. It was produced by a careful, doctrine-aware process aiming at a high degree of accuracy, but it has not been reviewed by a human translator and may contain errors. It is offered as a provisional translation for those texts of the Tibetan Buddhist canon that have not yet received an authoritative human translation. Where a published translation exists — above all from 84000: Translating the Words of the Buddha (84000.co) — that translation is definitive and should be preferred; please consult it instead. These translations are released into the public domain (CC0) in the spirit of spreading the Dharma to all corners of the earth.

Just as the Bodhi tree now standing at Bodh Gayā neither is nor is not the same tree beneath which the Buddha attained awakening, so too this stupa is intended as the next generation of stupa — dependently arising according to the conditions of its environment, and ceaselessly proclaiming the Dharma for the benefit of all sentient beings.

May whoever encounters these words derive great benefit.